Japanese Government (MEXT) Scholarship

サイドメニュー（英語）

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日本語

The following information is intended for prospective international students currently based overseas and wishing to attend Kyoto University on the Japanese Government (Monbukagakusho: MEXT) Scholarship.

For information for privately-financed international students currently enrolled at Kyoto University, see Scholarships for privately-financed international students.

- Categories
- Application period, eligibility, and benefits
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Categories

The Japanese Government (MEXT) Scholarship, funded by the Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT), is available to seven categories of students: 1) Research Students (Graduate-Degree Students and Research [non-degree] Students), 2) Teacher Training Students, 3) Undergraduate Students, 4) Japanese Studies

Students, 5) College of Technology Students, 6) Professional Training College Students, and 7) Young Leaders Program (YLP) Students.

Kyoto University accepts the following categories of international students:

Research Students	Undergraduate Students	Japanese Studies Students
Graduate degree and non-degree students	Undergraduate degree students	Credited auditors

Application period, eligibility, and benefits (as of November 2024)

The information provided below is based on past application guidelines and subject to change. Prospective applicants are advised to read the guidelines applicable to their intended year of entry.

Reference:

MEXT: "About the MEXT Scholarships"

The above webpage is written mostly in Japanese, but is linked to pages providing links to application guidelines in English.

Category	Research Students	Undergraduate Students[2]	Japanese Studies Students[3]
Application method	Overseas Selection		

	Embassy Recommendation	University Recommendation (general program)	Embassy Recommendation[4]	Embassy Recommendation	University Recommendation
Application	Around April – May	Around November	Around April – May	Around December	Around February[1]

period		– December[1]			
Arrival in Japan	Early April or late September of the following year	Late September	Around April of the following year	Late September of the following year	Late September
Selection	Evaluation of submitted documents, a written exam, an interview, and others				Evaluation of submitted documents, an

method				interview, and others
Eligibility	Those who have graduated, or expect to graduate, from an undergraduate or higher degree program	Those who have graduated, or expect to graduate, from a secondary school or equivalent	Overseas undergraduate students majoring in fields related to the Japanese language and/or culture (having studied these subjects for a total period of one year or more as of 1 September of the year they expect to arrive in Japan), and expecting to return to their home universities after completing a program in Japan	

Age (as of 1 April of the year of arrival)	34 or younger		24 or younger	18–29
Duration	Non-degree students: up to 2 years, including a six-month Japanese-l	Non-degree students:	Five years, including a one-year Japanese language	One year

	anguage training period[5, 6] (not mandatory for those with sufficient language skills)	up to 18 months[6]	training period[2]	
	Degree students (master's, professional, and doctoral): until completion of the degree program (not to exceed the standard number of years required)[6]			

Monthly stipend[7]	Non-degree students 143,000 yen Master's and professional-degree students 144,000 yen Doctoral students 145,000 yen	117,000 yen	117,000 yen
	Additional monthly payment:		

	3,000 yen for those studying/conducting research in Kyoto City 2,000 yen for those conducting research in Uji or Inuyama City
School fees[7]	Examination, admission, and tuition fees are exempted
Traveling cost[7]	One round-trip ticket is provided

1

These periods are for application through Kyoto University.

2

The language training is provided at either the Tokyo University of Foreign Studies or Osaka University during the first year of the scholarship period. The program includes Japanese language and other subjects needed to prepare for undergraduate studies, and must be completed before the student goes on to university. The university to be attended by the student for undergraduate studies is determined by MEXT in consultation with the preparatory educational institution and the university itself. For details, refer to the MEXT Scholarship application guidelines.

Please note that undergraduate MEXT Scholarship students are not eligible to enroll in the six-year programs at the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences' Division of Pharmacy and the Faculty of Medicine's School of Medical Science at Kyoto University.

3

For details on Kyoto University's Japanese studies program, see:

Japanese Studies Students Program (in Japanese).

4

University Recommendation is also available, but is limited to the following programs:

Undergraduate International Course Program of Civil Engineering, Undergraduate School of Civil, Environmental and Resources Engineering, Faculty of Engineering

Kyoto iUP

For details, please contact the administrative office of each program.

5

Intensive Japanese language training is available to MEXT Research and Teacher Training Students expecting to conduct graduate-level research in the Kyoto or Shiga region. For details, see Intensive Japanese Language Course for Monbukagakusho Scholarship Students.

6

Those wishing to go on to a master's, doctoral, or professional degree program may apply for an extension of the scholarship to cover their postgraduate studies. Applications are evaluated by the university and MEXT, and may be granted based on academic records and other criteria.

Please note that not all the applications are approved.

7

All scholarship benefits are subject to specified requirements.

Application procedures (overseas selection)

Pre-arrival applications should be submitted through either:

1) a Japanese diplomatic mission (Embassy Recommendation) or

2) a Japanese university (University Recommendation).

Most of the MEXT Scholarship students at Kyoto University earned their scholarships through Embassy Recommendation.

Note: For information for privately-financed international students currently enrolled at Kyoto University, see Scholarships for privately-financed international students.

1. Embassy Recommendation

To obtain an "Embassy Recommendation", applicants must submit their applications to the Japanese embassy, consulate, or other diplomatic mission in their home countries for the initial screening. Those interested are advised to contact an appropriate Japanese diplomatic mission in their countries.

In China, however, applications should be submitted to the country's Ministry of Education for the first screening. The application requirements, schedule, and process differ from those for Embassy Recommendation. Successful applicants usually arrive in Japan in October. Contact your home university in China or China Scholarship Council (CSC) for more details.

Regular schedule (subject to change)

Before arriving in Japan	April	Application
	May – August	Japanese diplomatic mission review ("first screening")
		In the case of research students: Application for a Letter of Provisional Acceptance from a Japanese university[10]

	October	MEXT review ("second screening")
	January - February	Notification of results
	March (September)[9]	Immigration procedures

During the stay in Japan	Early April (late September)[9]	Arrival in Japan	
		A. Research (non-degree) students: Japanese language training	B. Degree students:

		Preparation for entrance exams Conducting research	Undergraduate, master's, doctoral, or professional-degree studies[6] Note: Students need to have passed the entrance exam before the program begin
		Entrance examination	
		Undergraduate, master's, doctoral, or	

		professional-degree studies[6]	
Returning to home country			

Months in parentheses are for those arriving in late September.

See the following section: "For those wishing to obtain a Letter of Provisional Acceptance from Kyoto University".

For those wishing to obtain a Letter of Provisional Acceptance from Kyoto University

Follow the procedures outlined below after receiving the Passing Certificate of the First Screening or a notification of selection from a Japanese diplomatic mission.

Period for requesting a Letter of Provisional Acceptance

From the date of receipt of the Passing Certificate through Monday 1 September 2025 (JST)[11, 12]

11

Requests received on or after Tuesday 2 September will not be accepted.

12

Please note that some graduate schools/research institutes may close applications before 1 September 2025.

Procedures and contact method

1. **Choose a prospective academic advisor, such as by searching the [webpages listed below](#).**

   The University is not available to make any recommendations; applicants are responsible for selecting their academic advisors based on their own research interests.

2. **Obtain a Passing Certificate of the First Screening from a Japanese diplomatic mission, contact the prospective academic advisor, and request a Letter of Provisional Acceptance from that faculty.**

   Applicants may contact a prospective academic advisor in either of the following two ways:

   Directly or through the administrative office of the graduate school/research institute
   Contact information can be found via the following:
   Activity Database on Education and Research (for locating prospective academic advisors)
   Administrative offices

   Email requests for a Letter of Provisional Acceptance must have the following as the subject line:
   <MEXT: Embassy Recommendation> Application for a Letter of Provisional Acceptance
   As part of an online application process through the Admissions Assistance Office (AAO)
   AAO Application Procedures

For those applying via AAO

The University needs to receive the scholarship application documents in order to issue a letter of provisional acceptance. Please carefully read the AAO Guidelines linked below and submit your application accordingly.

AAO Guideline for applicants who passed the 1st screening of the MEXT Scholarship

Embassy Recommendation

Notes

It may take a month or more for the graduate school or the faculty member concerned to evaluate the submitted materials and make a decision about the application.

The above-mentioned date, 1 September 2025, is ***not*** the day when the application results are announced (successful applicants will be issued a completed Letter of Provisional Acceptance). It is therefore advisable to apply for the AAO process in plenty of time.

Those issued a Letter of Provisional Acceptance must apply not only for the scholarship but also for the University.

In particular, those wishing to enroll in a master's, doctoral, or professional-degree program are required to pass the entrance exam carried out by the graduate school concerned. Learn about the application period and other details by reading the guidelines provided on the graduate school websites.

Those who decide to withdraw their application after being issued a Letter of Provisional Acceptance are asked to immediately contact their prospective academic advisor.

University offices are closed on Saturdays, Sundays, and official holidays.

Please note that all administrative services, including replying to email inquiries, will be suspended on those days.

During August 2025, University offices will be closed on the following dates:

Monday 11 August (national holiday)

Tuesday 12 – Wednesday 13 August (University summer closure period)

Additionally, some offices, including the International Student Division, will be closed Thursday 14 – Friday 15 August as well.

Resources for finding a prospective academic advisor

Kyoto University Graduate Schools

Kyoto University Activity Database of Education and Research

Information on the education and research activities of KyotoU teaching staff can be found at the following websites as well:

Kyoto University Research Information Repository

Kyoto-U OpenCourseWare

Language of instruction

All Kyoto University undergraduate, master's, and professional degree courses and examinations, with the exception of English-taught degree programs, are generally conducted in the Japanese language. Therefore, most of those intending to enroll in the University's undergraduate, master's, and professional degree programs must have sufficient proficiency in Japanese at the time of matriculation.

Please read this page to learn about English-taught degree programs offered by the University, and this page for Japanese-language learning opportunities available after enrollment.

2. University Recommendation (general program)

The application process varies by graduate school, so prospective applicants are advised to contact the administrative office of the school they wish to apply for.

Kyoto University screens the applications and selects candidates to recommend to MEXT as research(non-degree), master's, professional-degree, or doctoral students. In general, those who do not intend to enter a degree (master's, doctoral, or professional) program are not eligible to apply for university recommendations. Those interested in an undergraduate program are advised to read Note 4 in "Application period, eligibility, and benefits".

Eligibility for the University Recommendation Scholarship (general program) is limited to nationals and citizens of the countries and regions designated by MEXT.

Graduate Schools

Regular schedule (subject to change)

Before arriving in Japan	November – December	Application
		Graduate School review*

	January	Kyoto University review*
	February – May	MEXT review
	Around June	Notification of results

	July – September	Immigration procedures
During the stay in Japan	Late September	Arrival in Japan

		A. Research (non-degree) students: Preparation for entrance exams Conducting research	B. Degree students: Undergraduate, master's, doctoral, or professional-degree studies[6] Note: Students need to have passed the entrance exam before the program begin
		Entrance examination	

		Undergraduate, master's, doctoral, or professional-degree studies[6]	
Returning to home country			

*

Each Graduate School may typically nominate one applicant to the University, and the University up to three applicants to MEXT.

Regarding the handling of personal information

Personal information provided at the time of application and personal information related to the application will be used for the scholarship screening process. The information may also be used for the general management of financial support data within the university, and for the management and screening of other projects within the university to facilitate its provision of appropriate support.

Contact

International Student Support Section

International Student Division

Kyoto University

Email: intlstudent*mail2.adm.kyoto-u.ac.jp (replace * with @)

Student exchange programs

Short-term international students